

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

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Theme: The gospel Story told from the life and events of Mephibosheth

2 Samuel 4:4 Jonathan's son of Saul had a son who was lame in both feet. He was five years old when the news about Saul and Jonathan came from Jezreel. His nurse picked him up and fled, but as she hurried to leave, he fell and became crippled. His name was Mephibosheth.) NIV

2 Samuel 9:6-13 6 When Mephibosheth son of Jonathan, the son of Saul, came to David, he bowed down to pay him honor. David said, "Mephibosheth!" "Your servant," he replied. 7 "Don't be afraid," David said to him, "for I will surely show you kindness for the sake of your father Jonathan. I will restore to you all the land that belonged to your grandfather Saul, and you will always eat at my table." 8 Mephibosheth bowed down and said, "What is your servant, that you should notice a dead dog like me?" 9 Then the king summoned Ziba, Saul's servant, and said to him, "I have given your master's grandson everything that belonged to Saul and his family. 10 You and your sons and your servants are to farm the land for him and bring in the crops, so that your master's grandson may be provided for. And Mephibosheth, grandson of your master, will always eat at my table." (Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants.) So, Mephibosheth ate at David's table like one of the king's sons. 13 And Mephibosheth lived in Jerusalem, because he always ate at the king's table, and he was crippled in both feet. NIV

King Saul slaughtered the Gibeonites?

◆ Now the Gibeonites were not of the children of Israel, but of the remnant of the Amorites: the children of Israel had sworn protection to them, but Saul had sought to kill them in his zeal for the children of Israel and Judah.

This resulted in Saul's family being killed

◆ King David Saul's successor, then granted the Gibeonites the jurisdiction to individually execute Saul's surviving two sons and five of Saul's grandsons (the sons of Merab and Adriel). The Gibeonites killed all seven, and hung up their bodies at the sanctuary at Gibeah.

1. MEPHIBOSHETH FELL – It was not his fault - he was accidentally dropped –

2 Samuel 4:4 (Jonathan's son of Saul had a son who was lame in both feet. He was five years old when the news about Saul and Jonathan came from Jezreel. His nurse picked him up and fled, but as she hurried to leave, he fell and became crippled. His name was Mephibosheth.) NIV

The Gospel story unfolding

■ ADAMS FALL WAS OUR FALL ALSO

◆ **We also fell when Adam fell – Adam's transgression constituted us as sinners estranged, separated from God and destined for judgement.**

Romans 5:19 Because one-person disobeyed God, many became sinners. NLT

Romans 5:19 And just as all people were made sinners as the result of the disobedience of one man. GNT

2. MEPHIBOSHETH WAS CRIPPLED – and could not walk – (paraplegic)

The Gospel story unfolding

■ THROUGH SIN WE ALSO BECAME CRIPPLED & LAME

◆ **We were disabled and crippled in many different ways spiritually, mentally emotionally and UNABLE to fulfill the righteous demands of the Law and INCAPABLE of walking with God; until he reconciled us and brought us back to himself.**

◆ **This crippled state made everything for difficult to attend to like it was told of Adam that he would till the ground with the sweat of his brow**

Genesis 3:17-19 17 And to the man he said, "Since you listened to your wife and ate from the tree whose fruit I commanded you not to eat, the ground is cursed because of you. All your life you will struggle to scratch a living from it. 18 It will grow thorns and thistles for you, though you will eat of its grains. 19 By the sweat of your brow will you have food to eat. NLT

3. DAVID SOUGHT TO FIND MEPHIBOSHETH -

■ HE INQUIRED AND SOUGHT OUT MEPHIBOSHETH TILL HE FOUND HIM.

◆ **David was concerned about Mephibosheth – and his living conditions because some of Saul's children and grandchildren were either killed and all their possessions forfeited.**

The Gospel story unfolding

- ◆ **God was looking for us** – *Jesus said, For the Son of Man came to seek and to save what was lost.* Luke 19:10 NIV
- ◆ **Jesus was searching for the sinner. He was wanting to invade their world and reconcile us to God the father.**
- ◆ **We were all like lost sheep and the shepherd went out “looking” for us.**

Isaiah 53:6 We all went astray like sheep; we all have turned to our own way; and the Lord has punished Him for the iniquity of us all. Holman

◆ **And David FOUND Mephibosheth**

- ◆ **Matthew 18:12-14** – Tells us of the shepherd that goes out and searches for the one lost sheep and when he finds it rejoices.
- ◆ **And take notice** – that it is not the will of your Father which is in heaven, that one of these little ones should perish.

4. DAVID SHOWED MERCY TO MEPHIBOSHETH

- **He showed mercy toward Mephibosheth because of his covenant friendship with Jonathon the father of Mephibosheth**

- ◆ **David overlooked the past evil action of his Mephibosheth grandfather (Saul)**

The Gospel story unfolding

- ◆ **God freely showed mercy to us when we were undeserving**
- ◆ **Jesus established a new covenant founded upon better promises and sealed by His blood**
- ◆ **for God loved us so much that through his mercy he gave us new lives.**

Ephesians 2:4 *But God is so rich in mercy, and he loved us so much,* NLT

Titus 3:5 He saved us, not because of the righteous things we had done, *but because of his mercy.* He washed away our sins, giving us a new birth and new life through the Holy Spirit. NLT

1 Peter 2:10 "Once you had no identity as a people; now you are God's people. Once you received no mercy; *now you have received God's mercy.*" NLT

5. RESTORED TO MEPHIBOSHETH ALL POSSESSIONS THAT HAD LOST AND ALSO MADE PROVISION FOR HIM FOR THE REMAINDER OF HIS LIFE.

The Gospel story unfolding

- ◆ **Through Christ's atoning death on the cross he restored our DIGNITY (lost through sin) and now we are unashamed – He gave us a new IDENTITY (who we really are as a person) – And he brought to us a new sense of WORTH and self-esteem.**
- ◆ **And as it states in Joel 2:25 - He has truly restored to us all that the locust (Sin) has eaten (destroyed) and will never be ashamed -**

Joel 2:25-27:25 "So I will restore to you the years that the swarming locust has eaten, The crawling locust, The consuming locust, And the chewing locust, My great army which I sent among you. 26 You shall eat in plenty and be satisfied, And praise the name of the Lord your God, Who has dealt wondrously with you; And My people shall never be put to shame. 27 Then you shall know that I am in the midst of Israel: I am the Lord your God And there is no other. My people shall never be put to shame. NKJV

AND SAT AT THE KINGS TABLE EVERY DAY LIKE ONE OF THE KINGS SONS - 2 Samuel 9:12-13 *So, Mephibosheth ate at David's table like one of the king's sons. 13 And Mephibosheth lived in Jerusalem, because he always ate at the king's table, and he was crippled in both feet.* NIV

The Gospel story unfolding

- ◆ **Eating every day at the king's table as a “king's son”**
- ◆ **Sons of God**

John 1:12 As many as received him, to them gave he power to become *the sons of God,* KJV

Galatians 4:5-7 - 5 to redeem those under the law, so that we might receive *adoption as sons.* 6 And *because you are sons,* God has sent the Spirit of His Son into our hearts, crying, "Abba, Father!" - 7 So you are no longer a slave, *but a son;* and *if a son, then* an heir through God. Holman Christian Standard Bible

1 John 3:2 Beloved, *now are we the sons of God,* and it doth not yet appear what we shall be: but we know that, when he shall appear, *we shall be like him;* for we shall see him as he is. Webster

Hebrews 12:7 Endure it as discipline: *God is dealing with you as sons.* For what son is there whom a father does not discipline? Holman

◆ **Reigning in life as kings**

Romans 5:17 For if because of one man's trespass (lapse, offense) death reigned through that one, much more surely will those who receive [God's] overflowing grace (unmerited favor) and the free gift of righteousness [putting them into right standing with Himself] *reign as kings in life* through the one Man Jesus Christ (the Messiah, the Anointed One). AMP

Romans 5:17 For if one man's offence meant that men should be slaves to death all their lives, it is a far greater thing that through another man, Jesus Christ, men by their acceptance of his more than sufficient grace and righteousness, *should live all their lives like kings!* PHILLIPS
AMEN Ps Barry